EE5203 Lab 5 Guide

Button interrupts: replace polling with EXTI - Basri Erdogan

Mission: Configure B1 (PC13) as a falling-edge interrupt so that one valid press toggles the LED on PA5 — without reading the button anywhere in `while (1)`.

This lab uses Lecture 6 (EXTI, NVIC, callbacks, `volatile` flags, debounce).

Prepare before class

- ☐ Bring your board and a USB **data** cable.
- ☐ Do the **Lab 5 pre-lab quiz** on CATS.
- ☐ Re-read the theory slides up to "The complete interrupt path with register names".
- ☐ Know why pressing B1 produces a *falling* edge on PC13.

Learning objectives

By checkoff time, you can:

1. configure an EXTI pin and enable its NVIC request in CubeMX;
2. prove with a breakpoint that the interrupt path reaches your callback;
3. pass an event from the callback to `main()` with a `volatile` flag;
4. debounce the button so one press produces exactly one event.

Hardware and files

Item	Value
Board	Nucleo-F401RE: LED on PA5, B1 on PC13 (external pull-up, **low while pressed**), no wiring
Tools	STM32CubeMX (new project) + VS Code
Project name	`EE5203_L05_<studentnumber>`
File you edit	`main.c`, only inside the `USER CODE` regions
Screenshots	**Win + Shift + S** (Mac: **Cmd + Shift + 4**); save as PNG with the name in each checkpoint

ℹ Using your own laptop? (click)

Follow the steps as written, with these changes. Set up your laptop once with the Home Setup Guide.

- **Folder:** `C:\STM32\EE5203` (Mac: `~/STM32/EE5203`), not `C:\Work`.
- **Step 5:** skip it. Open the folder, choose **Debug**, then ST icon → **Set Up STM32Cube project(s)**.
- **Build / debug: F7** (Mac: **fn + F7**), then Run and Debug → **STM32Cube: STM32 Launch ST-Link GDB Server**.
- **End of session:** no *Save to H*. Your project stays on your laptop.

Checkpoint A - New EXTI project and callback proof

Start of the session: if `C:\Work\<studentnumber>` does not contain your Lab 4 project, copy **all** your project folders from `H:\EE_Labs` into it first.

1. **STM32CubeMX:** Board Selector → **NUCLEO-F401RE** → accept the default initialization. Set up **PA5** as in Lab 4: **Reset_State**, then `GPIO_Output`, User Label empty.
2. Keep **PC13** as `GPIO_EXTI13`. In System Core → GPIO, PC13: **External Interrupt Mode with Falling edge trigger detection**, **No pull-up and no pull-down** (the board's resistor already holds PC13 high).
3. In System Core → **NVIC**: enable **EXTI line[15:10] interrupts** (PC13 is line 13; lines 10–15 share this entry). Leave the priority at its default.
4. Project Manager: name **`EE5203_L05_<studentnumber>`**, location `C:\Work\<studentnumber>`, Toolchain/IDE = **CMake** → Generate Code.
5. Copy `C:\Users\Public\EE5203_template\.vscode` into the project folder.
6. Check the generated setup in `MX_GPIO_Init()`:

```
GPIO_InitStruct.Mode = GPIO_MODE_IT_FALLING;
GPIO_InitStruct.Pull = GPIO_NOPULL;
HAL_NVIC_EnableIRQ(EXTI15_10_IRQn);
```

7. **In `USER CODE BEGIN 4`** (near the end of `main.c`, after `MX_GPIO_Init()`), add the callback:

```c
void HAL_GPIO_EXTI_Callback(uint16_t GPIO_Pin)
{
    if (GPIO_Pin == GPIO_PIN_13) {
        HAL_GPIO_TogglePin(GPIOA, GPIO_PIN_5);
    }
}
```

8. Build (**Ctrl+Shift+B**), start the debugger (**F5**), Continue, press B1: the LED responds without any button code in the loop.

Show: put a breakpoint on the `if` line and press B1. The program stops there, and VARIABLES shows `GPIO_Pin` = `8192` (this is `GPIO_PIN_13`). **Screenshot `A_callback.png`:** this stop, with `GPIO_Pin` visible.

Checkpoint B - The callback reports, the loop acts

Move the LED action from the callback to the main loop, in **three** changes:

1. **In `USER CODE BEGIN PV`**, add the flag:

```c
volatile uint8_t button_event = 0;
```

2. **In the callback** (`USER CODE BEGIN 4`), replace the `HAL_GPIO_TogglePin` line with `button_event = 1;`:

```c
void HAL_GPIO_EXTI_Callback(uint16_t GPIO_Pin)
{
    if (GPIO_Pin == GPIO_PIN_13) {
        button_event = 1;           /* only record the event */
    }
}
```

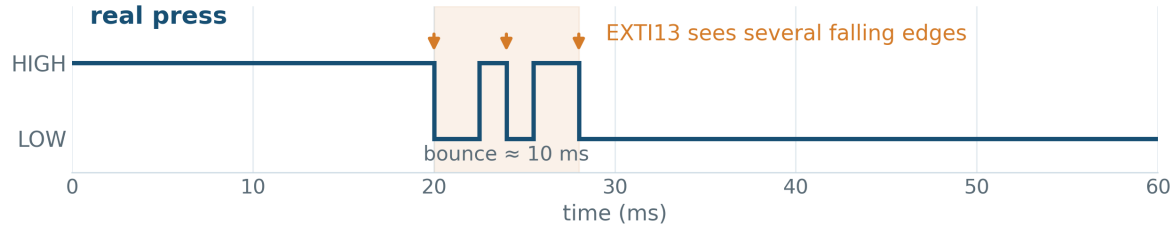
3. **In `USER CODE BEGIN 3`**, add the LED action:

```c
if (button_event == 1) {
    button_event = 0;               /* consume before acting */
    HAL_GPIO_TogglePin(GPIOA, GPIO_PIN_5);
}
```

Show: the callback only sets `button_event = 1;`. Put a breakpoint on the `HAL_GPIO_TogglePin` line in the loop and press B1: the program stops there. **Screenshot `B_main_loop.png`:** this stop, with `main` at the top of CALL STACK.

Checkpoint C - One press, one event

A real contact bounces — several falling edges per press:



Accept a press only when at least 80 ms has passed since the last accepted one. Make **two** changes in `main.c`, then test:

1. **In `USER CODE BEGIN PV`**, below `button_event`, add the time of the last press:

```c
uint32_t last_press_ms = 0;
```

2. **In the callback** (`USER CODE BEGIN 4`), replace `button_event = 1;` with the 80 ms guard:

```c
void HAL_GPIO_EXTI_Callback(uint16_t GPIO_Pin)
{
    if (GPIO_Pin == GPIO_PIN_13) {
        uint32_t now = HAL_GetTick();
        if ((now - last_press_ms) >= 80) {     /* 80 ms since the last press? */
            last_press_ms = now;
            button_event = 1;
        }
    }
}
```

   The subtraction stays correct even when the millisecond counter wraps.

3. **Test the board**, not only the build. If something is wrong, write down what you see *before* you change the code.

Test	Expected observation
press once slowly	LED toggles once
press ten times	LED toggles ten times
hold B1 down	no repeated toggling
release B1	no toggle

Show: remove all breakpoints and do the four tests for your lab assistant. No screenshot.

Checkpoint D - Two valid presses per toggle

No code is given. Toggle the LED only after **two** valid presses. Count the presses in the main loop. Do not change the callback or the 80 ms guard.

Show: press B1 four times slowly: the LED toggles exactly two times. Then say in one sentence in which function your counter is. **Screenshot `D_counter.png`:** your `USER CODE BEGIN 3` code.

Optional (not graded) - Two-state LED control

Each valid press switches between `STEADY` and `BLINK` (LED toggles every 250 ms). Time it with `HAL_GetTick()`, not `HAL_Delay()`.

Common problems

Show the table (click)

Fix the **first** failed stage along the path B1/PC13 → EXTI13 → `EXTI15_10_IRQn` → handler → callback → `button_event` → main loop.

What you see	First check
The callback breakpoint is never hit	PC13 is `GPIO_EXTI13` and **EXTI line[15:10]** is enabled in NVIC; you generated code again.
The callback runs, the LED does not change	Inspect `GPIO_Pin`: compare with `GPIO_PIN_13`.
The LED toggles on **release**	Rising edge selected: choose falling edge in CubeMX.
The flag is set, `main()` never sees it	`button_event` is not declared `volatile`.
Several toggles per press	The 80 ms guard or `last_press_ms = now;` is missing.
The LED never lights	PA5 is `GPIO_Output` in the `.ioc`.
My code disappeared after Generate Code	It was outside `USER CODE`. Paste it again inside the region.
`...FLASH.ld: syntax error`	Build with **Ctrl+Shift+B**; check that `.vscode` is in the project folder.
`...FLASH.ld: syntax error` on your own laptop	Replace `FLASH.ld` with the file from the Home Setup Guide (step 6). Repeat after every Generate Code.

End of the session - Save to H

Show the steps (click)

Close VS Code, run the **Save to H** desktop shortcut, and check that `H:\EE_Labs\EE5203_L05_<studentnumber>` exists before you log out.

Acceptance checklist

- ☐ `.ioc`: PC13 = `GPIO_EXTI13`, falling edge, no pull, NVIC enabled; code only inside `USER CODE`.
- ☐ Checkpoint A: the callback breakpoint is hit on a press (`A_callback.png`).
- ☐ Checkpoint B: `button_event` is `volatile`; the LED action lives in `main()` (`B_main_loop.png`).
- ☐ Checkpoint C: the four tests pass, one toggle per press.
- ☐ Checkpoint D: four presses, two toggles (`D_counter.png`).

Individual oral check

Be ready for **one** question **or** one live change, chosen by your lab assistant. For a live change, predict the result first, then make the change.

Questions:

- Why does B1 use a falling edge and no internal pull?
- What runs first: `EXTI15_10_IRQHandler()` or your callback?
- Why must the callback stay short, and why is `volatile` required?
- What would happen without the 80 ms guard?

Live changes:

- Set PC13 to the rising edge in CubeMX. When does the LED toggle now?
- Turn off **EXTI line[15:10]** in NVIC. Does the callback still run?
- Change the guard from 80 ms to 1000 ms and press B1 quickly several times.

Submit

Submit `main.c`, the `.ioc` file, `A_callback.png`, `B_main_loop.png` and `D_counter.png`.

Marks (10): pre-lab quiz on CATS 1 · A project and callback proof 2 · B event flag 2 · C debounce tests 2 · D two presses per toggle 1 · oral check (one question or one live change) 2.